(SHMCL)[17] Meeting at the Chushul–Moldo meeting point on the Chinese side (Moldo) in the first week of June 2020.

The first SHMCL meeting took place as scheduled at Moldo. Both sides had delegations comprising the field commanders on either side. The IA delegation also had representation from the ITBP. On the PLA side, their Political Commissar was also part of the delegation. It was a marathon meeting lasting close to twelve hours, primarily because of the time spent in translation, breaks to confer in private and administrative breaks. As a result of these discussions, both sides agreed to disengage from the friction points of PP-14, PP-15 and PP-17A. The PLA was not keen on discussing the situation on the North Bank. When the matter was brought up, they countered by saying that we could settle the smaller issues first and then move on to bigger issues. The exact modalities for the disengagement were to be worked out through HMCL[18] meetings at respective locations and levels. Whenever these meetings took place, and many more would happen in the future, there was no official record or minutes of the meeting. The decisions arrived at were only in the nature of 'in-principle' agreements subject to ratification at appropriate levels on either side, in our case by the CSG. This arrangement had an inherent drawback in that what was said and understood by either party could be at variance based on individual perceptions, and there was no method to protect against any retraction from what had been agreed upon 'in-principle'. This was to have grave repercussions later on.

The Galwan River flows from East to West, before joining the Shyok River at KM 120 on the Darbuk–Shyok–Daulat Beg Oldi (DSDBO) road, where there is an IA outpost. From this forward operating base, patrols would go up to PP-14 periodically. The distance from KM 120 to PP-14 is hardly 10 km as the crow flies but much longer by foot along the banks of the river, having

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